had been released, which had the song '*Piya Tu Ab Toh Aaja*', with the lyrics going something like, 'Monica, oh my darling'. Needless to say, we used to go around singing that song in our tuneless voices much to the annoyance of our classmate. From DK 1 to the school perched on a small hillock was a short walk. There was no Army Hospital Research and Referral or Air Force Auditorium. We would just cut across the scree, plucking berries to supplement our tiffin. There was no Arjan Vihar, and Pratap Chowk was still under construction, with piles of sand lying around in which we would search for seashells while dawdling back from school. After lunch and a bit of rest, it was off to play. We were not allowed to be indoors between 4 and 7 p.m. This time was spent playing whatever game was the flavour—hockey, football or cricket—or climbing the gulmohar trees that lined the colony roads. By 7 p.m. we had to be back and there would be words if we were even a minute late. On most days, we returned with a bruise or two, skinned knees and elbows, or a swelling somewhere but that was all set right with a refreshing bath, comprising a bucket full of water with a cap-full of Dettol in it. At the onset of summer, my father would take us all to the Air Force Station MI Room, where we would be inoculated against typhoid, cholera and tetanus. It was a yearly ritual, after which we could do what we wanted. Summers were also dedicated to swimming. The Defence Services Officers' Institute (DSOI) was part of DK 1 and had a small bean-shaped pool. We would be at the pool dot at 4 p.m., which was the pool opening time and splash about till we were chased out by the lifeguard once the kids' hours were over. I learnt to swim in the DSOI pool. Our favourite game was to throw a small coin in the deep end and then dive down to retrieve it. Sometimes, four or five of us would go up to the three-metre diving board, run along it and jump down

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